TRT 15

Tamoxifen

Non-steroidal anti-estrogen taken by mouth; competes with estrogen for receptors in tissues such as breast



CLASS
Small molecule (SERM)

STUDIED FOR
Breast cancer, breast growth

HUMAN EVIDENCE
Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS
FDA approved (generics, Soltamox)

STUDIED FOR

- **Breast cancer** — HUMAN
- **Breast growth** — HUMAN
- **Sperm counts** — HUMAN
- **Hormones in men** — HUMAN

Men: one approved use. Metastatic breast cancer in men is approved. Use for breast growth, testosterone or fertility is off-label.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Tamoxifen ▶ Estrogen receptor ▶ Blocks estrogen ▶ LH, FSH, T rise

- **Label:** competes with estradiol for the estrogen receptor
- **Label:** has some estrogen-like effects, which may explain uterine effects
- **Label:** in men with low sperm counts, raised LH, FSH, testosterone, estrogen
- **Tumor shrinkage** described in rats (animal data)

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Approved 1977 on large trials in women
- Men with breast cancer: 66 of 132 responded
- RCTs in men: 151 and 282 on bicalutamide

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use in healthy men
- Dose for off-label uses

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
About 5 to 7 days (label)

ROUTES STUDIED
By mouth (tablets, oral solution)

PHARMACOKINETICS
Peak about 5 hours; extensively metabolized (label)

SOLD AS
Prescription tablets (generics), Soltamox solution

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Blood counts, liver tests (label)

SPORT (WADA)
Prohibited, class S4

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved 1977; boxed warning for some women
FDA	Off-label: breast growth, testosterone
WADA	Prohibited at all times (S4.2)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, tamoxifen citrate tablets label (Mylan), Aug 2026
2. Eur Urol, tamoxifen dose-response on bicalutamide (Fradet et al.), Jul 2007
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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